Extra Dessert #10: DX, Contest, and Remote Operating

Contest practices, DX pileups, QSL managers, LoTW, Cabrillo and ADIF formats, mesh networks, and remote operation.

Group E2C · 12 pool questions · Self-study reference · Practice exams at eham.net/exams

Log And File Formats

Format	Purpose	Q
ADIF	File format for **exchanging amateur radio log data**	E2C02
Cabrillo	Standard for **submission of electronic contest logs**	E2C07

Contest Operating

Question	Answer	Q
Band excluded from contesting	**30 meters**	E2C03
VHF/UHF contest SSB/CW activity location	**Weak-signal segment of the band, near the calling frequency**	E2C06
Identifying when calling a DX station in a pileup	**Send your full call sign once or twice**	E2C11

DX Operating

Question	Answer	Q
Function of a DX QSL Manager	**Handle the receiving and sending of confirmations for a DX station**	E2C05
Why DX often works split (different TX/RX frequencies)	DX may be on a frequency prohibited to some + separates calling stations from the DX + improves efficiency by reducing QRM – **all of the above**	E2C10
LoTW (Logbook of The World) covers	Special event contacts in US + US-to-non-US contacts + Worked All States – **all of the above**	E2C08

Remote Operation

Question	Answer	Q
Indicator required when remote-operating a US-located station	**No additional indicator is required**	E2C01
Term for delay between control op action and transmitted change	**Latency**	E2C12

Mesh Networks

Question	Answer	Q
Frequencies for amateur mesh networks	**Frequencies shared with various unlicensed wireless data services** (mostly 2.4 GHz and 5 GHz Wi-Fi bands, where amateur and Part 15 share)	E2C04
Equipment used	**A wireless router running custom firmware** (e.g., AREDN)	E2C09

Dessert 10 Question Bank (E2C)

E2C01. What indicator is required to be used by US-licensed operators when operating a station via remote control and the remote transmitter is located in the US?
A. / followed by the USPS two-letter abbreviation for the state in which the remote station is located.
B. /R# where # is the district of the remote station.
C. / followed by the ARRL Section of the remote station.
D. No additional indicator is required.

E2C02. Which of the following file formats is used for exchanging amateur radio log data?
A. NEC.
B. ARLD.
C. ADIF.
D. OCF.

E2C03. From which of the following bands is amateur radio contesting generally excluded?
A. 30 meters.
B. 6 meters.
C. 70 centimeters.
D. 33 centimeters.

E2C04. Which of the following frequencies can be used for amateur radio mesh networks?
A. HF frequencies where digital communications are permitted.
B. Frequencies shared with various unlicensed wireless data services.
C. Cable TV channels 41-43.
D. The 60-meter band channel centered on 5373 kHz.

E2C05. What is the function of a DX QSL Manager?
A. Allocate frequencies for DXpeditions.
B. Handle the receiving and sending of confirmations for a DX station.
C. Run a net to allow many stations to contact a rare DX station.
D. Communicate to a DXpedition about propagation, band openings, pileup conditions, etc.

E2C06. During a VHF/UHF contest, in which band segment would you expect to find the highest level of SSB or CW activity?
A. At the top of each band, usually in a segment reserved for contests.
B. In the middle of each band, usually on the national calling frequency.
C. In the weak signal segment of the band, with most of the activity near the calling frequency.
D. In the middle of the band, usually 25 kHz above the national calling frequency.

E2C07. What is the Cabrillo format?
A. A standard for submission of electronic contest logs.
B. A method of exchanging information during a contest QSO.
C. The most common set of contest rules.
D. A digital protocol specifically designed for rapid contest exchanges.

E2C08. Which of the following contacts may be confirmed through the Logbook of The World (LoTW)?
A. Special event contacts between stations in the US.
B. Contacts between a US station and a non-US station.
C. Contacts for Worked All States credit.
D. All these choices are correct.

E2C09. What type of equipment is commonly used to implement an amateur radio mesh network?
A. A 2-meter VHF transceiver with a 1,200-baud modem.
B. A computer running EchoLink to provide interface from the radio to the internet.
C. A wireless router running custom firmware.
D. A 440 MHz transceiver with a 9,600-baud modem.

E2C10. Why do DX stations often transmit and receive on different frequencies?
A. Because the DX station may be transmitting on a frequency that is prohibited to some responding stations.
B. To separate the calling stations from the DX station.
C. To improve operating efficiency by reducing interference.
D. All these choices are correct.

E2C11. How should you generally identify your station when attempting to contact a DX station during a contest or in a pileup?
A. Send your full call sign once or twice.
B. Send only the last two letters of your call sign until you make contact.
C. Send your full call sign and grid square.
D. Send the call sign of the DX station three times, the words “this is,” then your call sign three times.

E2C12. What indicates the delay between a control operator action and the corresponding change in the transmitted signal?
A. Jitter.
B. Hang time.
C. Latency.
D. Anti-VOX.

Answer Key

E2C01: D	E2C02: C	E2C03: A	E2C04: B
E2C05: B	E2C06: C	E2C07: A	E2C08: D
E2C09: C	E2C10: D	E2C11: A	E2C12: C